Gabriel / Chosen

Current company version · generated from the structured master script

CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

SCENE 3 — Mary (Jordyn), Talia (Tasha), Shira(Tyfany), Adina(Jeovanie), Dafna(Ashley)

CONTINUOUS FROM SCENE 2

Joseph has just exited.

JOSEPH
Tomorrow?

MARY
Tomorrow.

Joseph disappears.

Mary remains alone.

For several seconds, nothing happens.

Let the audience stay with her happiness.

Mary looks toward the place Joseph exited.

She smiles.

She begins quietly putting things in order.

Perhaps she

folds a piece of cloth;

straightens the unfinished table piece Joseph showed her;

moves one of the chairs;

touches the wood and imagines the future they were just discussing.

She catches herself smiling.

MARY
Eight chairs.

She shakes her head.

MARY
Joseph...

Small laugh.

She resumes folding.

THE INTERRUPTION

The distant sounds of Nazareth are still present.

A voice.

A cart.

A child somewhere outside.

A faint hammer.

Then—

everything stops.

Not slowly.

Gone.

Mary notices.

She waits.

MARY
Hello?

Nothing.

She listens.

MARY
Is someone there?

A subtle musical texture enters.

Something completely different from the musical language of Nazareth.

Not loud.

Not threatening.

Unfamiliar.

The light begins changing.

Mary turns.

She sees GABRIEL.

Gabriel does not rush toward her.

Stillness is part of the power of the moment.

GABRIEL
Mary.

Mary steps backward.

MARY
Who are you?

GABRIEL
Do not be afraid.

MARY
I wasn't—

She stops.

MARY
I… ok, wait…

Mary stops and backs away

Gabriel remains calm.

GABRIEL
You have found favor with God.

Gabriel walks towards Mary

MARY
Favor?

Still walks away from Gabriel slowly

GABRIEL
Yes.

Continues walking towards Mary

MARY
I don't understand.

Still walks backwards away from Gabriel

GABRIEL
You will.

Continues walking towards Mary

Beat.

MARY
Who are you?

Still walks backwards away from Gabriel

GABRIEL
Gabriel.

A beat.

Stops walking and stands still

GABRIEL
I have been sent by God.

Mary stops, she absorbs that.

She looks toward the doorway, as though part of her still expects someone else to walk in and make this ordinary again.

No one does.

THE CALLING

GABRIEL
Mary...

you have been chosen.

Mary looks at him.

MARY
Chosen for what?

GABRIEL
You will bear a son.

Silence.

Mary does not respond.

MARY
I'm sorry—

what did you say?

GABRIEL
You will bear a son.

MARY
No.

Not rejection.

Her mind simply cannot make the words fit.

MARY
I mean—

how?

Beat.

MARY
How can that be?

GABRIEL
What will happen comes from God.

MARY
I understand the words.

Beat.

MARY
I don't understand how they can be true.

GABRIEL
Nothing God has spoken is beyond His power.

Mary looks at him carefully.

MARY
Why me?

GABRIEL
Because God has chosen you.

MARY
That doesn't answer the question.

Gabriel regards her.

Not offended.

GABRIEL
It may be the only answer you are given tonight.

That lands.

MARY SEARCHES FOR CERTAINTY

MARY
You expect me to believe this?

GABRIEL
I expect you to decide whether you will trust the One who sent me.

MARY
Those aren't the same thing.

GABRIEL
No.

They are not.

Mary studies him.

That answer surprises her.

MARY
What happens now?

GABRIEL
You live the answer.

MARY
That's all?

GABRIEL
No.

Beat.

GABRIEL
Your relative Elizabeth is also expecting a child.

Mary looks up.

MARY
Elizabeth?

GABRIEL
Yes.

MARY
But she—

Mary stops herself.

She knows what she was going to say.

GABRIEL
What seemed impossible...

is already happening.

Mary takes that in.

This is the first piece of the message she can attach to something in her world.

MARY
Elizabeth.

GABRIEL
Go to her if you need to see what God has already begun.

THE COST ARRIVES

Mary looks toward the unfinished table.

The future from Scene 2 is sitting in front of her.

The house.

The table.

The marriage.

Joseph.

Her breathing changes slightly.

MARY
What will people think?

Gabriel does not answer immediately.

MARY
My family?

The village?

Still no false reassurance.

MARY
Joseph...

That name lands hardest.

MARY
What am I supposed to tell Joseph?

GABRIEL
The truth.

MARY
And if the truth sounds impossible?

GABRIEL
It will still be the truth.

MARY
That doesn't mean he'll believe me.

GABRIEL
No.

Mary looks at Gabriel.

That is not the answer she wanted.

MARY
You don't know Joseph.

GABRIEL
God does.

MARY
He has plans.

Her eyes move back to the table.

MARY
We have plans.

A home.

A wedding.

A family.

Beat.

MARY
He thinks he knows how our life is supposed to go.

GABRIEL
And you?

Mary looks at him.

MARY
Until a moment ago...

so did I.

MUSICAL TRIGGER — “CHOSEN”

The first musical phrase begins.

Not triumph.

Not celebration.

A question.

Gabriel does not suddenly disappear.

He remains present, but the focus begins transferring to Mary.

The song begins because she has finally understood

This miracle has a cost.

“CHOSEN”

SONG JOURNEY

SECTION 1 — WHY ME?

Mary confronts the word chosen.

She is not royalty.

Not powerful.

Not extraordinary by the world's standards.

Why would God place something this enormous in the hands of someone from Nazareth?

The lyrical thought should be

Why would being chosen feel this frightening?

SECTION 2 — WHAT WILL THIS COST?

Mary sees everything from Scene 2 in a new light

Joseph;

their wedding;

the house;

the table;

her family;

her name;

what Nazareth will say;

whether Joseph will stay.

Fragments of the musical language of “My Beloved” may briefly appear underneath “Chosen.”

Not a full reprise.

Just enough for the audience to feel the future that is now endangered.

SECTION 3 — I CANNOT SEE THE ROAD

Mary begins understanding that Gabriel is not going to give her the entire future.

She does not know

what Joseph will do;

how people will react;

where this road ends;

what obedience will cost.

The central realization

> *I do not have to see the whole road to take the next step.*

SECTION 4 — CHOSEN BECOMES A CHOICE

The word changes meaning.

At the beginning of the song

> *God chose me.*

By the end

> *Will I choose to trust God?*

Possible central lyrical territory

> *Chosen doesn't mean unafraid.*

and/or

> *If You chose me, give me courage to choose You.*

The music grows emotionally—

but avoid turning it into a giant power-ballad finish.

This should feel like Mary becoming steady, not invincible.

THE MUSIC APPROACHES ITS FINAL RESOLUTION

Mary turns toward Gabriel.

The music holds.

Then—

nearly stops.

Silence.

Mary breathes.

She is still afraid.

That matters.

MARY
I don't understand what comes next.

GABRIEL
I know.

MARY
And I'm afraid.

GABRIEL
I know.

Beat.

MARY
But if God has asked this of me...

She gathers herself.

MARY
I am the Lord's servant.

Beat.

MARY
Let it be with me as He has said.

Silence.

No instant explosion of music.

No triumphant celebration.

Let the decision stand by itself.

Gabriel regards her.

For the first time, there may be something almost tender in his expression.

GABRIEL
Do not be afraid, Mary.

Mary takes a breath.

MARY
I'm trying.

GABRIEL
That is enough for tonight.

GABRIEL DEPARTS

The light around Gabriel begins to change.

Do not make his departure a magic trick simply for spectacle.

It can be

a controlled fade;

a shift in light;

Gabriel moving into darkness;

Mary's attention being pulled briefly elsewhere and finding him gone.

The divine musical texture recedes.

Mary is alone again.

Same room.

Same wood.

Same cloth.

Same unfinished table.

Nothing looks different.

Everything is different.

FINAL MOMENT

Mary stands quietly.

She touches the unfinished table.

A faint fragment of “My Beloved” is heard.

Perhaps only a few notes.

Mary remembers

“Whatever comes, I'll walk with you.”

Her expression changes.

Not because she regrets saying yes.

Because now she understands what she has to do next.

She looks toward the direction Joseph left.

MARY
Joseph...

Blackout or controlled transition.

END SCENE 3